

02-25-2025 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wIAiF2s-42c
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Target Category	mcs

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2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer Mr. Williams called the Muncie Community Schools board meeting to order [00:05:28](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Presiding Officer:** Mr. Williams (Board President)
 - **Administrators Present:** Dr. Reynolds (Superintendent), Dr. Bell, Mr. Drome (Director of Financial/Business operations or similar administrative staff), and other district staff/principals.
 - **Board Members Present:** Spoken roll call indicated members present [00:07:07](#). Specific board members addressing items or participating include Mr. Williams, Dr. Bell, and Dr. Reynolds.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by the board [00:06:40](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** [Note: Prior meeting minutes approval is typically bundled within the standard consent agenda; specific roll or voice counts for prior minutes were not individually broken out outside of the general consent approval block] [01:01:42](#).

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:07:38 Grissom Elementary School Presentation & Operational Update

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Grissom Elementary School Principal (along with Assistant Principal Ryan Mason, School Counselor Miss Johnson, and Student Assistance Coordinator Mrs. Stone).
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Enrollment averages remain steady compared to the 2023<U+2013>2024 school year.
 - The school highlighted instructional assistant support in primary grades and the addition of a third resource teacher and instructional assistants for IEP students at the semester.
 - Grissom received two major recognitions from the Indiana Department of Education: a **Purple Star School** designation (for commitment to military-connected families) and an **Early Literacy Award** (one of only three schools in the state awarded).
 - Facility improvements included new landscaping installed by Smoots over fall break.
 - **Discipline & MTSS Frameworks:** Assistant Principal Ryan Mason reported on behavior models aiming for a 20% decrease in out-of-school suspensions. Strategies include streamlined MTSS grouping, SEL groups, Breakfast Buddies/Lunch Bunch, a revamped PBIS system featuring an "Astro store" and "Awesome Astros" weekly recognition, and proactive parent communication via ParentSquare and re-entry/preventative conferences.
 - **Drum Circle Initiative:** Principal and staff demonstrated a music/drum circle model used to teach impulse control, teamwork, and social-emotional skills, featuring student participants and board members.
 - **Third Grade Literacy Focus ("IREAD-3"):** Extensive board discussion regarding third-grade reading benchmarks, ufly phonics curriculum, targeted small-group testing environments, and upcoming bubble-student interventions from March to May. Attendance rates were reported at approximately 92%, buoyed by home visits and dedicated staff support.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None (student and staff presentation).
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no board action required.

00:39:46 Black History Month Program & Essay Recognition

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** District Equity/Program presenter, joined by Longfellow Elementary School teacher Andrea Strey and third-grade students (Genesis, Violet, Jamaria, Tyro).
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Highlighted the MLK Dream Team Black History Month essay contest (noting high school freshman Michaela Gibson's winning essay on Harriet Tubman).

- Reviewed the district-wide Black History Month door/bulletin board decorating contest spanning the month of January, judged by local university professors and community leaders.
 - Recognized **Longfellow Elementary School (Teacher Andrea Strey and third-grade students)** as the overall District Winner for their interactive “Henry Box Brown” display.
 - The presenter shared an original poem titled “Color,” emphasizing unity and kindness.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational celebration and student recognition; no formal vote required. (The board informally agreed to sponsor a pizza party for the winning class).
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01:01:42 Consent Agenda & New Personnel / Retirement Approvals

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Administration / Board President Mr. Williams.
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Presented routine consent agenda items including new hires (Austin Rogers, Donald Watkins, Eugenia Beaver) and the retirement of Central High School art teacher Stacy Gill after 25 years of service.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [01:02:39](#).
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01:02:45 Permission to Advertise: Food Service Management Company RFP/RFQ

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Drome (Business/Finance Department).
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Mr. Drome requested board permission to advertise for bids for the Food Service Management Company contract, a mandatory 5-year federal/state cycle required by the USDA and implemented through the Indiana Department of Education (IDOE).
 - The district previously utilized Chartwells for the past five years.
 - The timeline includes a pre-bid vendor tour around April 4th, bid openings due April 10th at 10:00 AM (which IDOE now mandates be live-streamed), and final contract recommendations brought back to the board on May 13th. Scoring is based on a structured 10-component IDOE matrix including pricing, local family farm food integration, experience, and references.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [01:08:07](#).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- *Note: No general public comment or citizen forum period was conducted during this segment of the meeting transcript.*
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **Strategic Plan & Surveys:** Dr. K<U+2019>s consultancy survey results regarding the strategic plan will be forwarded to board members later in the week. Feedback collection continues through March and April.
 - **Central High School Security:** Superintendent Dr. Reynolds reported a successful launch of the new weapons detection system at Central High School, noting positive family and student cooperation despite cold morning weather.
 - **Black History Month Concert Series:** The final district Black History Month music concert featuring fourth and fifth graders is scheduled for Thursday at 1:15 PM at Central High School.
 - **Athletics:** Muncie Community Schools will host the boys basketball sectionals next week at the historic Fieldhouse, with Muncie drawing a bye to play in the second game on Friday evening.
 - **Community Partnerships:** Ball State University provided 100 basketball tickets as student incentives for South and North middle schools. The local YMCA grand opening is scheduled for March 8th.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned following a motion and voice vote [01:15:52](#).
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